

## STEPHENMILESPEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, we're here in Gladstone in Queensland and we have a very special guest with us, Stephen Miles who is the Queensland Opposition leader, former Premier of the magnificent State of Queensland. Stephen, welcome to the program. G'day, thanks for having me.

Now Stephen, a lot of people don't realise overseas to our program that Queensland is a quarter of the size of the United States and as Premier you actually travel all around the great state of Queensland. Tell us about some of your favourite places. Look, you're right, it is an enormous state.

You know, Brisbane to Cairns is further than London to Istanbul and that gives you a sense of the scale of it. Cairns is only two-thirds the way up the coast, so there's a lot of Queensland even further than Cairns at the great honour of being first up the Environment Minister, so I got to see some of the most beautiful parts of the state from the Great Barrier Reef to the Outback to the Cape, Torres Strait and it really is, there is just so much to explore. It's a beautiful state and especially where we are at the moment, Gladstone here, we're right at the start of the Great Barrier Reef and as Environment Minister in the past, you've had a lot to do with the reef as well.

Well, that's right. I was the first Minister for the Great Barrier Reef. I was a key part of the effort to make sure it stayed on the World Heritage List because that's really important both for the reef as well as our tourism industry and I got to see so much of the Great Barrier Reef, particularly the Southern Great Barrier Reef here off Cairns, it's still very pristine and so if you want a fantastic diving experience or reef experience, Southern Great Barrier Reef is a great place to start.

I must congratulate you because you were instrumental in creating the 50 Cent Fairs which are in Brisbane, Gold Coast, South East Queensland and it's really driven a lot of people back to public transport. It has and it's really pushed a lot of visitors and tourists onto our public transport which is fantastic too. We're hearing a lot of people aren't hiring a car now, they're choosing to use public transport to get around.

It's something I've wanted to do ever since I grew up in the outer suburbs and it always struck me that we charged the people we wanted to use public transport the most to use that public transport and 50 Cent Fairs was all about getting them off the roads and onto trains and buses and ferries and it's proven effective. Now your area, Moreton Bay, where your seat is and you're the current opposition leader of the state and tell us about that area for people who don't know about it. Moreton Bay is a beautiful part of the South East just north of Brisbane, so it's the local government area between Brisbane City and Sunshine Coast and it runs all the way from the ocean.

So you've got ocean side suburbs like Redcliffe out to the hinterland places like Dabra and

Samford and so it's a very very large area, very fast growing area, lots of lots of young families, but that brings with it a real vibrancy that makes it an exciting place to live. Great that you've stayed on as opposition leader. I mean we have a new government here, but what are your plans for the future building up to the next election? You've had tremendous experience as the Premier.

Yeah, I was fortunate enough to spend 10 years in government. We're the opposition now and that means our job changes a lot right now. It's really about holding the government to account for the promises that they make and demanding that they do a better job for Queensland.

Obviously, as we get closer to the next election, we start outlining our plans for the state's future and we will have big plans for the state's future. It's an incredible state with a big bright future and we want to help shape it. Now as Premier of Queensland, you got to travel I suppose extensively in Southeast Asia around the world occasionally and yeah, what are people's views about Australia when you run into those people overseas and especially the state of Queensland? I didn't actually travel overseas at all when I was the Premier, but when I was the State Development Minister, there was a lot of work to be done building on our trade relationships, building on our economic opportunities and everywhere I went there was a real affection for the state and affection for the long-held trading relationships that Queensland has with our trading partners and there's still a lot more opportunities in that for Queensland.

Great. Well, thank you Steven Miles, leader of the Queensland State Opposition and former Premier of Queensland. Thank you very much for being on the show and can you say hello to our Travel Radio Australia audience out there? Hello to everyone listening out there.

I hope you come to Queensland. We'll see you when you do. Thanks very much.